



Croup

Severity	Symptoms/Signs	Management
Mild	Seal like Barking cough	Dexamethasone PO 0.15 mg/kg Single dose.
Moderate	Seal like Barking cough , Stridor , Sternal recession at rest N.B: Moderate needs hospital referral	Dexamethasone PO 0.15 mg/kg Single dose. OR Prednisolone PO 1mg/kg Single dose. OR Neb Budesonide 2mg Single dose.
Severe	Same as Moderate with Agitation and lethargy	Call Ambulance Oxygen Dexamethasone PO 0.15 mg/kg Single dose.
Impeding respiratory failure	Sternal/Intercostal recession Asynchronous chest wall & abdominal movement , Fatigue, Pallor or Cyanosis Decreased level of consciousness , Tachycardia RR > 70 breath/min	OR Prednisolone PO 1mg/kg Single dose. OR Neb Budesonide 2mg Single dose.

Westley Croup Severity Score

Clinical Feature	Assigned Score
Level of consciousness	Normal, including sleep = 0 Disoriented = 5
Cyanosis	None = 0 With agitation = 4 At rest = 5
Stridor	None = 0 With agitation = 1 At rest = 2
Air entry	Normal = 0 Decreased = 1 Markedly decreased = 2
Retractions	None = 0 Mild = 1 Moderate = 2 Severe = 3

Score	Severity	Description	Management
≤ 2	Mild	- Occasional barking cough - No stridor at rest - Mild or no retractions	- Home treatment (antipyretic, fluids, mist) - Outpatient: Single dose PO dexamethasone
3 to 7	Moderate	- Frequent barking cough - Stridor at rest - Mild to moderate retractions - No or little distress or agitation	- Single dose PO dexamethasone - Nebulized epinephrine - Hospitalization not generally needed
8 to 11	Severe	- Frequent barking cough - Stridor at rest - Marked retractions - significant distress and agitation	- Single dose PO/IM/IV dexamethasone - Repeated doses of nebulized epinephrine prn - inpatient admission usually required - Improved after corticosteroid and nebulized epinephrine
≥ 12	Impending respiratory failure	- Depressed level of consciousness - Stridor at rest - Severe retractions - Poor air entry - Cyanosis or pallor	- Single dose PO/IM/IV dexamethasone - Repeated doses of nebulized epinephrine prn - ICU admission usually required - May require intubation